

ordinate arrangements for UN system activities in Viet Nam.

■ **Zaire — Technical Assistance in Preparedness Planning:** The Resident Representative in Kinshasa has informed UNDRO that the Government is requesting UNDRO's assistance in setting up a disaster preparedness programme. UNDRO has offered to send a staff member to review and update a project report, drafted by UNDRO in 1979, which the Government wishes to implement.

INFORMATION, COMMUNICATIONS, EXCHANGE OF VIEWS AND CONTACTS

Latin American and Caribbean countries: At the invitation of the Executive Secretary of the Inter-American Economic and Social Council (CIES), an UNDRO delegate from the New York Liaison Office attended the XXth Ministerial Meeting of the Council in Washington, D.C. in late 1985, and took part in the discussions relating to the problems of disasters and development in Latin American and Caribbean countries.

Africa: An UNDRO delegate participated in the special meeting of the Organization for African Unity/Economic Commission for Africa (OAU/ECA) and relevant organizations of the UN system in Addis Ababa, January 6, 1986. The purpose of this special inter-agency meeting was to agree on preparations, for the special session of the General Assembly on the Critical Economic Situation in Africa.

Executive Director of the World Food Council delivered a lecture for members of the international community in Geneva on the subject of Emergency Food Aid to Africa — The High Risk of Permanent Dependence. An abridged version of Mr. William's lecture will be published in the March/April issue.



Mr. M. Williams (left) and the UNDRO Co-ordinator Mr. M. Essaafi.

The next UNDRO lecture will be given on 6 March 1986 by His Eminence Cardinal Roger Etchegaray, President of Cor Unum on the topic "Et qui est mon prochain? Blessures du monde et charité de l'Eglise."

A briefing on UNDRO's mandate and activities was given in Geneva, by a relief co-ordination officer to some 20 visiting students of the St. Lawrence University, New York, on 17 January.

UNDRO Data Base: The Bibliographical data base is now complete with well over 2,000 entries. Work is in progress on the Master Distribution and Country Profile data bases.